



# A Motion to Change Venue for the Riemann Hypothesis

RE-CENTERING ARITHMETIC: THE FINITE-PLACE DIVISIBILITY SPECTRUM AND ITS LOG-SCALE BOUNDARY

Daniel Rodriguez

$$K(m, n) = \frac{\gcd(m, n)}{\sqrt{mn}}$$

FIG. 0 THE INSTRUMENT. ONE KERNEL, ENTERED THREE TIMES: AS OVERLAP, AS SPECTRUM, AS RESPONSE.

## ■ AN ARGUMENT

A MOTION, NOT A PROOF · THE STANDARD IS PREPONDERANCE

I want to file a motion, not a proof, and the standard I ask to be held to is preponderance: that re-centering arithmetic around the critical line of the Riemann zeta function is more likely than not the right way for the field to proceed.

A motion must first declare what it does not contain. The Riemann Hypothesis is not proved here. No Hilbert-Polya operator is constructed. The Weil explicit formula is not derived from the normalized gcd kernel, and the zeta zeros are not shown to be the spectrum of a self-adjoint operator.

What the motion does contain is precise:

The normalized gcd kernel gives a genuine finite-place Hilbert geometry of divisibility. More precisely, it is both the Gram kernel of normalized divisibility sets in the profinite integers and the Fourier transform of an explicit product of local Poisson measures on the prime torus. Under the log-scale flow, the direct finite Euler shadows do not converge to the completed Weil functional as length-side cargo; the same finite shadows do, however, become exact matrix coefficients of a diagonal scale flow. Their logarithmic radial derivatives isolate the prime-power distribution in the explicit formula. The far-bank condition is completed Weil positivity, and by Weil's criterion that condition is RH-strength.

The thesis underneath the motion is unchanged: cancellation does not know its sign until it is represented as length. The positivity the Hypothesis demands becomes visible only when the algebra is represented in a Hilbert geometry, where positivity is inherited rather than verified. The response interpretation sharpens the thesis: the operator is not the source of the arithmetic. The scale generator is nearly empty. The state carries the information, and at the critical boundary the state is what must be renormalized.

The guiding slogan is:

divisibility has a finite-place spectral shadow.

That shadow is real. It is proved below as overlap, as spectrum, and as finite response. The bridge from the shadow to the Hypothesis is the completed boundary-state positivity problem, and it stays open on every page of this essay.

Re-centering of this kind is not a strange request; it is how arithmetic has often developed: zero installed rather than found; negative quantities used while still called absurd; the diagonal of the unit square housed in a continuum built because no ratio would hold it; the square root of a negative number promoted from tolerated fiction to axis. When an absence is structured, persistent, and resistant to the standing coordinates, the historical remedy has been to rebuild the coordinates around it.

■ WHAT IS PROVED, WHAT IS KNOWN, WHAT IS PROPOSED

FOUR CURRENCIES,  
KEPT SEPARATE

The reader should not have to guess which kind of sentence is being spoken. The argument uses proved mathematics, known theorems, and speculative interpretation. They are different currencies.

A fourth currency has entered since the first edition: machine-checked. The companion repository, riemann-venue, verifies the motion's checkable rows in Lean 4 against Mathlib. Where a row names a declaration, the Lean kernel has checked it, and the verification does not require trusting the author. The row-by-row index is the repository's status ledger.

|                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ✓ MACHINE-CHECKED | <p>The normalized gcd kernel <math>K(m, n) = \gcd(m, n) / \sqrt{mn}</math> is positive definite</p> <p>Proved below by a Gram representation in <math>L^2(\hat{\mathbb{Z}})</math>; positive definiteness of gcd matrices is classical, from Smith determinants to Beslin and Ligh, as cited by Guillot and Wu; machine-checked in the repository as <code>normalizedGcdKernel_posSemidef</code>, via the Gram factorization <code>gcdMatrix_eq_factorization</code>.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| ✓ MACHINE-CHECKED | <p><math>K</math> extends to a positive-definite function <math>\kappa</math> on <math>\mathbb{Q}_+^\times</math></p> <p>Proved below from unique factorization; machine-checked as <code>kappa_posSemidef</code>.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| ✓ MACHINE-CHECKED | <p><math>\kappa</math> has an explicit spectral measure on the prime torus <math>\mathbb{T}^{\mathcal{P}}</math></p> <p>Proved below using the Poisson kernel and the Bochner-Herglotz theorem; the identification of gcd sums with Poisson integrals on the polydisc is on the record; machine-checked on the infinite prime torus as <code>integral_character_infinitePoisson_half_eq_kappa</code>.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| ✓ MACHINE-CHECKED | <p>The family of prime-torus product measures <math>\mu_\sigma = \bigotimes_p P_{p^{-\sigma}} d\theta_p / (2\pi)</math> changes type at <math>\sigma = 1/2</math></p> <p>Proved below from Kakutani's infinite-product criterion: equivalent to Haar for <math>\sigma &gt; 1/2</math>, singular for <math>0 &lt; \sigma \leq 1/2</math>; both directions machine-checked (<code>poissonProduct_dichotomy</code>), and the dichotomy itself is formalized (<code>infinitePi_mutuallySingular</code>, <code>infinitePi_absolutelyContinuous_of_summable</code>); to the author's knowledge the first formalization of Kakutani (1948) in any proof assistant.</p> |
| ✓ MACHINE-CHECKED | <p>Pulling finite prime-torus products along the log-scale flow produces positive finite Euler shadows</p> <p>Proved below; machine-checked as <code>hasSum_primeShadow</code>.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| ✓ MACHINE-CHECKED | <p>Finite Euler shadows are exact matrix coefficients of a trivial scaling generator in a finite divisibility vacuum</p> <p>Proved below; this is the response interpretation of the same object that fails as cargo; machine-checked as <code>response_eq_poisson</code>.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| ■ PROVED          | <p>The scale flow preserves the product-measure class of <math>\mu_\sigma</math> for nonzero shifts exactly above the critical threshold</p> <p>Proved below from Kakutani's criterion and the classical zero-free line <math>\zeta(1 + iu) \neq 0</math> for <math>u \neq 0</math>; the criterion series and the Hellinger-deficit bridge are machine-checked (<code>kakutani_criterion_summable_iff</code>, <code>summable_hellinger_deficit_iff</code>); the translate version remains prose.</p>                                                                                                                                                            |
| ✗ FALSE AS STATED | <p>Those finite products converge directly to the completed Weil functional</p> <p>False as stated; the direct shadows have arbitrary rational frequencies and fail to converge as Radon measures near zero; the failure itself is machine-checked as <code>not_summable_kappa_consecutive</code>.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

|                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ■ KNOWN           | <p>The normalized infinite one-sided response is the classical Riemann zeta distribution, and the two-sided divisibility response is its symmetrized autocorrelation in the absolutely convergent range</p> <p>Classical, recorded by Lin and Hu as a theorem of Khinchine; proved below from the Euler product.</p>                                                       |
| ✓ MACHINE-CHECKED | <p>The logarithmic radial derivatives of the finite shadows isolate the prime-power distribution in the explicit formula</p> <p>Proved below at the finite-place level; equivalently, they are the radial derivatives of the prime-power Lévy measure; machine-checked end to end as <code>hasDerivAt_sum_primePower_terms</code>.</p>                                     |
| ■ KNOWN           | <p>The archimedean Gaussian gives the gamma factor of the completed zeta function</p> <p>Known from Tate's thesis; restated against Mathlib in the repository (<code>completed_zeta_eq_gamma_mul_tsum</code>).</p>                                                                                                                                                         |
| ■ KNOWN           | <p>The completed Weil distribution is obtained by adding gamma, pole, and trivial-zero corrections to the prime-power distribution</p> <p>Known from the explicit formula, with convention-dependent signs.</p>                                                                                                                                                            |
| ■ KNOWN           | <p>Weil positivity of the completed explicit-formula functional is equivalent to RH</p> <p>Known from Weil's criterion; Bombieri describes the associated quadratic functional as positive semidefinite if and only if RH holds; the statement shape is fenced formally in the repository (<code>WeilPositivity</code>), with the equivalence deliberately not stated.</p> |
| ■ OPEN            | <p>A positive trace identity realizes the Weil functional as <math>\text{Tr}(\pi(f)^*\pi(f))</math></p> <p>Conjectural; proving it for the correct completed functional would contain the unresolved RH-strength positivity.</p>                                                                                                                                           |
| ■ OPEN            | <p>A modular flow from Tomita-Takesaki theory has spectrum given by the zeta zeros</p> <p>Speculative; not proved here.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

The finite-place spectral theorem is the unconditional core. The boundary theorem explains why the most tempting direct limit fails, why the same object survives as response, and why the logarithmic derivative, not the raw product, is the operation that reaches the explicit formula. Together they substantiate the essay's intuition while keeping the RH-strength claim fenced off.

■ THE ROUTE THROUGH THE CONSTRUCTION

NO NEW INSTRUMENT · THE EXISTING ONES, ROUTED

The construction must be read in the right order, and the right order is very nearly the order in which its instruments entered the record. Smith evaluated the determinant of the gcd matrix in 1876. Herglotz and Bochner turned positive-definite functions into spectral measures in the early twentieth century. Khinchine's zeta distribution put the Euler product into probability. Kakutani settled the dichotomy for infinite product measures in 1948. Tate completed the zeta function through harmonic analysis in 1950. Weil sharpened the Hypothesis into a positivity criterion in 1952. Tomita-Takesaki theory manufactured canonical time from states around 1970. Bost and Connes built the noncommutative crossing in 1995, and Connes aimed it at the zeros in 1999.

The motion adds no new instrument. It routes the existing ones, and the first step is not an operator, a trace, or a modular flow. It is the elementary Hilbert-space fact that normalized divisibility sets have the normalized gcd kernel as their Gram matrix; then harmonic analysis, the same kernel as the Fourier transform of a product of local Poisson measures on the dual of  $\mathbb{Q}_+^\times$ ; then the boundary, where real log-scale produces positive finite products that are not the Weil functional as measures; then the response reading, the same products as exact matrix coefficients of a trivial diagonal scale generator; then the corrective transformation, logarithm and radial differentiation, removing the rational-frequency clutter and leaving prime powers. Only after that does the familiar completed explicit formula enter, adding the archimedean gamma term and pole corrections.

The missing positivity is therefore not hidden in the gcd kernel. It sits at the end of this chain:

Gram positivity  $\rightarrow$  prime-torus spectral measure  $\rightarrow$  log-scale boundary  $\rightarrow$  finite response  
 $\rightarrow$  logarithmic derivative  $\rightarrow$  completed Weil distribution  $\rightarrow$  Weil positivity .

Every arrow before the completed positivity can be stated precisely. The last arrow is RH.

## ■ THE FAILURE OF CANCELLATION

WHAT WOULD MAKE IT STABLE AT THE CRITICAL SCALE

The Möbius function is the local grammar of cancellation. In the incidence-algebra setting that Rota systematized, the Möbius function is the convolution inverse of the zeta function of a partially ordered set. For the divisibility poset of positive integers, Rota explicitly identifies the classical Möbius function with the Möbius function of divisibility and identifies formal Dirichlet series with the corresponding incidence subalgebra.

In finite incidence algebras, cancellation closes:

$$\mu * \zeta = \delta.$$

In the Dirichlet-series version, inside the half-plane of absolute convergence  $\operatorname{Re}(s) > 1$ , the same inverse appears as

$$\zeta(s) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{1}{n^s} = \prod_p (1 - p^{-s})^{-1}, \quad \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{\mu(n)}{n^s} = \frac{1}{\zeta(s)}.$$

After analytic continuation, the reciprocal is meromorphic, and the nontrivial zeros of  $\zeta$  become poles of the continued inverse. The standard analytic account is correct. The question is what kind of object would make this cancellation stable at the critical scale.

The modern record already teaches the shape of the answer. Selberg's trace formula puts Laplacian eigenvalues and closed-geodesic lengths into one identity. Hilbert and Polya are reputed to have suggested that the zeros of  $\zeta$  should be eigenvalues of a suitable self-adjoint operator. Weil's explicit formula turns the zeros-primes relation into a distributional identity, and Weil's positivity criterion says that RH is equivalent to positivity of a specific quadratic functional. Connes interprets the explicit formulas as a trace formula on the noncommutative space of adèle classes, while Connes, Consani, and Marcolli formulate the relevant number-field analogue as a Lefschetz trace formula whose positivity pairing is equivalent to RH.

The pattern is not that every positivity is the same positivity. These notions must not be identified without maps between them. The governing pattern is this:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{finite-place positivity} &\neq \text{Tate zeta integral positivity} \neq \\ \text{Tomita-Takesaki modular positivity} &\neq \text{Weil positivity} . \end{aligned}$$

These are neighboring rooms, not one room. The essay's task is to show the doors and name the locked one.

## ■ THE FINITE-PLACE GRAM KERNEL

DIVISIBILITY AS OVERLAP

Let  $\hat{\mathbb{Z}} = \prod_p \mathbb{Z}_p$  be the profinite integers, with normalized Haar measure. For a positive integer  $n$ , define

$$D_n = n\hat{\mathbb{Z}}.$$

Then  $D_n$  has measure  $1/n$ . Normalize its indicator function:

$$e_n = \sqrt{n} 1_{D_n} \in L^2(\hat{\mathbb{Z}}).$$

The intersection of two divisibility sets is controlled by the least common multiple:

$$D_m \cap D_n = \text{lcm}(m, n) \hat{\mathbb{Z}}.$$

Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} \langle e_m, e_n \rangle &= \sqrt{mn} \text{vol}(D_m \cap D_n) \\ &= \frac{\sqrt{mn}}{\text{lcm}(m, n)} \\ &= \frac{\gcd(m, n)}{\sqrt{mn}}. \end{aligned}$$

So

$$K(m, n) = \frac{\gcd(m, n)}{\sqrt{mn}}$$

is a positive Gram kernel. For every finite family of coefficients  $c_n$ ,

$$\sum_{m, n} \overline{c_m} c_n K(m, n) = \left\| \sum_n c_n e_n \right\|^2 \geq 0.$$

This is the first unconditional object.

#### FIRST SAFETY RAIL

It represents overlap between normalized divisibility sets. It does not yet represent the Weil functional. That distinction is the first safety rail.

Notice the exponent. The vector  $1_{D_n}$  has norm  $n^{-1/2}$ , and the normalization multiplies by  $\sqrt{n}$ . Thus the same half-density that later appears at the critical line already appears in the most elementary finite-place geometry. This does not prove RH; it explains why the kernel is naturally centered at exponent  $1/2$ .

## ■ THE FINITE-PLACE SPECTRAL THEOREM

DIVISIBILITY AS SPECTRUM

The Gram model has a second, more spectral face.

Let

$$G = \mathbb{Q}_+^\times.$$

By unique factorization,

$$\mathbb{Q}_+^\times \cong \bigoplus_{p \in \mathcal{P}} \mathbb{Z}, \quad q = \prod_p p^{v_p(q)},$$

where only finitely many exponents  $v_p(q)$  are nonzero. Define

$$\kappa(q) = \prod_p p^{-|v_p(q)|/2}.$$

Only finitely many factors differ from 1, so  $\kappa$  is well-defined. For positive integers  $m, n$ ,

$$\kappa(m/n) = \prod_p p^{-|v_p(m) - v_p(n)|/2} = \frac{\gcd(m, n)}{\sqrt{mn}}.$$

The Pontryagin dual of  $G$  is the infinite prime torus

$$\hat{G} \cong \mathbb{T}^{\mathcal{P}}.$$

A point  $z = (z_p)_p \in \mathbb{T}^{\mathcal{P}}$  defines a character

$$\chi_z(q) = \prod_p z_p^{v_p(q)}.$$

Again the product is finite for each  $q$ .

For each prime  $p$ , put a local Poisson measure on the circle:

$$d\mu_p(e^{i\theta}) = \frac{1 - p^{-1}}{|1 - p^{-1/2}e^{i\theta}|^2} \frac{d\theta}{2\pi}.$$

Equivalently, with  $a = p^{-1/2}$ ,

$$P_a(\theta) = \frac{1 - a^2}{1 - 2a \cos \theta + a^2} = \frac{1 - a^2}{|1 - ae^{i\theta}|^2}.$$

The Fourier expansion is

$$P_a(\theta) = \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} a^{|k|} e^{ik\theta}, \quad 0 < a < 1.$$

Thus

$$\int_{\mathbb{T}} z^k d\mu_p(z) = p^{-|k|/2}.$$

Now form the product probability measure

$$\mu = \bigotimes_p \mu_p$$

on  $\mathbb{T}^{\mathcal{P}}$ . This is a product measure specified by its finite-dimensional cylinder marginals. One should not treat it as an ordinary infinite density with respect to Haar measure. That warning matters later.

For  $q = \prod_p p^{k_p} \in \mathbb{Q}_+^{\times}$ ,

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{\mathbb{T}^{\mathcal{P}}} \chi_z(q) d\mu(z) &= \int_{\mathbb{T}^{\mathcal{P}}} \prod_p z_p^{k_p} d \bigotimes_p \mu_p(z) \\ &= \prod_p \int_{\mathbb{T}} z_p^{k_p} d\mu_p(z_p) \\ &= \prod_p p^{-|k_p|/2} \\ &= \kappa(q). \end{aligned}$$

So the finite-place theorem is:

**Finite-place divisibility spectrum.** The positive-definite function

$$\kappa(q) = \prod_p p^{-|v_p(q)|/2}$$

on  $\mathbb{Q}_+^{\times}$  is the Fourier transform of the product Poisson measure  $\mu = \bigotimes_p \mu_p$  on the prime torus  $\mathbb{T}^{\mathcal{P}}$ :

$$\kappa(q) = \int_{\mathbb{T}^{\mathcal{P}}} \chi_z(q) d\mu(z).$$

This is the Bochner-Herglotz content of the normalized gcd kernel.

For integers  $m, n$  define

$$\chi_n(z) = \prod_p z_p^{v_p(n)}.$$

Then

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \chi_m, \chi_n \rangle_{L^2(\mathbb{T}^p, \mu)} &= \int_{\mathbb{T}^p} \chi_m(z) \overline{\chi_n(z)} d\mu(z) \\ &= \int_{\mathbb{T}^p} \chi_z(m/n) d\mu(z) \\ &= \kappa(m/n) \\ &= \frac{\gcd(m, n)}{\sqrt{mn}}. \end{aligned}$$

So the normalized gcd kernel has two exact models:

$$\frac{\gcd(m, n)}{\sqrt{mn}} = \langle \sqrt{m} 1_{m\hat{\mathbb{Z}}}, \sqrt{n} 1_{n\hat{\mathbb{Z}}} \rangle = \int_{\mathbb{T}^p} \chi_m(z) \overline{\chi_n(z)} d\mu(z).$$

The first model is divisibility as overlap. The second is divisibility as a finite-place spectral measure. Together they form the unconditional finite-place theorem.

## ■ THE FIRST LOCKED DOOR: HAAR SINGULARITY AT THE CRITICAL EXPONENT

A PHASE BOUNDARY

The prime-torus measure is not a harmless infinite density. Introduce the parameter

$$d\mu_{\sigma, p}(e^{i\theta}) = P_{p^{-\sigma}}(\theta) \frac{d\theta}{2\pi}, \quad \mu_\sigma = \bigotimes_p \mu_{\sigma, p}, \quad \sigma > 0.$$

Compare  $\mu_\sigma$  with Haar measure

$$\lambda = \bigotimes_p \frac{d\theta_p}{2\pi}$$

on  $\mathbb{T}^p$ . Kakutani's theorem on infinite product measures says that equivalence or singularity of two product measures is controlled by the product of the local Hellinger integrals. This is the same world as Riesz product measures, where infinite products of positive trigonometric factors can become singular even though every finite partial product is absolutely continuous.

The local Hellinger integral is

$$H_p(\sigma) = \int_{\mathbb{T}} \sqrt{P_{p^{-\sigma}}(\theta)} \frac{d\theta}{2\pi}.$$

For small  $a$ ,

$$\int_{\mathbb{T}} \sqrt{P_a(\theta)} \frac{d\theta}{2\pi} = 1 - \frac{a^2}{4} + O(a^4).$$

With  $a = p^{-\sigma}$ , this gives

$$H_p(\sigma) = 1 - \frac{1}{4p^{2\sigma}} + O(p^{-4\sigma}).$$

Therefore

$$\prod_p H_p(\sigma) > 0 \quad \text{when} \quad \sum_p p^{-2\sigma} < \infty,$$

and

$$\prod_p H_p(\sigma) = 0 \quad \text{when} \quad \sum_p p^{-2\sigma} = \infty.$$

Since

$$\sum_p p^{-2\sigma} < \infty \quad (\sigma > 1/2), \quad \sum_p p^{-2\sigma} = \infty \quad (0 < \sigma \leq 1/2),$$

Kakutani's criterion gives the threshold

$$\mu_\sigma \sim \lambda \quad (\sigma > 1/2), \quad \mu_\sigma \perp \lambda \quad (0 < \sigma \leq 1/2).$$

The critical normalization  $p^{-1/2}$  is therefore the exact product-measure boundary. This does not prove RH. It says something more local and more useful: the same exponent that normalizes divisibility sets is the exponent at which the prime-torus Poisson product becomes singular relative to Haar measure. The critical line is not imported as metaphor. It appears as a measure-theoretic phase boundary.

There is a sharper version: compare  $\mu_\sigma$  with its own translate under log-scale.

For  $u \in \mathbb{R}$ , define the scale shift on the prime torus by

$$T_u \left( (z_p)_p \right) = (p^{iu} z_p)_p.$$

At the  $p$ th circle, this is the rotation  $\theta \mapsto \theta + u \log p$ . Compare the local Poisson measure  $P_{p^{-\sigma}}(\theta) d\theta / (2\pi)$  with its rotated copy. The local Hellinger deficit is, for small  $a$ ,

$$1 - \int_{\mathbb{T}} \sqrt{P_a(\theta) P_a(\theta + t)} \frac{d\theta}{2\pi} \asymp a^2 (1 - \cos t),$$

uniformly for bounded  $t$ . With  $a = p^{-\sigma}$  and  $t = u \log p$ , Kakutani's criterion reduces quasi-invariance of the product measure under  $T_u$  to the convergence of

$$\sum_p p^{-2\sigma} (1 - \cos(u \log p)).$$

For  $\sigma > 1/2$  this converges absolutely. For  $0 < \sigma < 1/2$  it diverges for every nonzero  $u$ . At the boundary  $\sigma = 1/2$ , the series becomes

$$\sum_p \frac{1 - \cos(u \log p)}{p}.$$

Here the first half diverges by the pole of  $\zeta(s)$  at  $s = 1$ . The oscillatory half

$$\sum_p \frac{\cos(u \log p)}{p}$$

converges with bounded partial sums for  $u \neq 0$ , the mode of convergence Kakutani's criterion consumes, since the full series has nonnegative terms. This is Prime Number Theorem strength: it reflects the classical fact that  $\zeta(1 + iu)$  is finite and nonzero off  $u = 0$ , the Hadamard–de la Vallée Poussin zero-free line. Thus the nonzero scale shifts are expelled at the same threshold:

$$(T_u)_* \mu_\sigma \sim \mu_\sigma \quad (\sigma > 1/2),$$

while

$$(T_u)_* \mu_\sigma \perp \mu_\sigma \quad (0 < \sigma \leq 1/2, u \neq 0).$$

The exception  $u = 0$  is the identity. This strengthens the singularity statement. At the critical exponent the measure is not merely singular relative to Haar; the scale flow itself refuses to act within its measure class. The vacuum is not transported across the boundary as a measure.

## ■ THE LOG-SCALE FLOW

FAILS AS CARGO, SURVIVES AS RESPONSE

There is a natural one-parameter flow from real scale into the prime torus:

$$j : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{T}^{\mathcal{P}}, \quad j(u) = (p^{iu})_p.$$

For every integer  $n$ ,

$$\chi_n(j(u)) = n^{iu}.$$

This is the reason the prime torus is tempting. Its characters become Dirichlet frequencies on logarithmic scale. Unique factorization implies rational independence of the numbers  $\log p$ : if  $\sum_{p \in S} a_p \log p = 0$  with integers  $a_p$ , then  $\prod_{p \in S} p^{a_p} = 1$ , hence every  $a_p = 0$ . By Kronecker's theorem, the line  $u \mapsto (p^{iu})_{p \in S}$  is dense in each finite prime subtorus.

### SECOND SAFETY RAIL

But density is not restriction of measure. The product measure  $\mu_{1/2}$  is already singular relative to Haar on the infinite torus. There is no automatic operation that restricts  $\mu_{1/2}$  to the dense log-scale orbit and produces the Weil functional. This is the second safety rail.

For a finite set of primes  $S$ , pulling the finite product along  $j$  gives the positive finite Euler shadow

$$F_S(u) = \prod_{p \in S} P_{p^{-1/2}}(u \log p) = \prod_{p \in S} \frac{1 - p^{-1}}{|1 - p^{-1/2 - iu}|^2}.$$

Equivalently,

$$F_S(u) = \prod_{p \in S} (1 - p^{-1}) \left| \prod_{p \in S} (1 - p^{-1/2 - iu})^{-1} \right|^2.$$

This is where the finite-place spectral measure begins to resemble the square of an Euler product. But resemblance is not convergence.

The Fourier expansion of  $F_S$  is

$$F_S(u) = \sum_{q \in \langle S \rangle} \kappa(q) e^{iu \log q},$$

where  $\langle S \rangle$  is the subgroup of  $\mathbb{Q}_+^\times$  generated by the primes in  $S$ . On the length side, this corresponds to

$$\nu_S = \sum_{q \in \langle S \rangle} \kappa(q) \delta_{\log q}.$$

The direct limit of these length-side measures is not a Radon measure. The obstruction is already at zero. Take

$$q_n = \frac{n+1}{n}.$$

Then  $\log q_n \rightarrow 0$  and, since  $n$  and  $n+1$  are coprime,

$$\kappa(q_n) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{n(n+1)}} \sim \frac{1}{n}.$$

Thus every neighborhood of 0 receives divergent mass:

$$\sum_{n \text{ large}} \kappa((n+1)/n) = \infty.$$

There is also a support mismatch. The direct product has frequencies  $\log q$  for arbitrary rational ratios  $q \in \mathbb{Q}_+^\times$ . The prime side of the explicit formula has prime-power lengths

$$\pm r \log p.$$

So the finite shadows do not converge directly to the completed Weil functional. The direct product is too large. It contains all rational-frequency interference terms.

This negative result is not a failure of the program. It is a correction of the map.

The direct length-side measure fails to cross the infinite-prime limit. But the same finite object has a second reading: it is an autocorrelation.

Fix a finite set of primes  $S$  and a radius exponent  $\alpha > 0$ . Put

$$\kappa_{\alpha,S}(q) = \prod_{p \in S} p^{-\alpha |v_p(q)|}, \quad q \in \langle S \rangle,$$

and define a vector in  $\ell^2(\langle S \rangle)$  by

$$\xi_{S,\alpha} = \sum_{q \in \langle S \rangle} \kappa_{\alpha,S}(q)^{1/2} |q\rangle.$$

The sum is square-summable because  $S$  is finite. Let the scale flow be the diagonal unitary

$$U_u |q\rangle = q^{iu} |q\rangle = e^{iu \log q} |q\rangle.$$

Then the finite Poisson shadow is exactly the matrix coefficient

$$F_{S,\alpha}(u) = \prod_{p \in S} P_{p^{-\alpha}}(u \log p) = \sum_{q \in \langle S \rangle} \kappa_{\alpha,S}(q) e^{iu \log q} = \langle \xi_{S,\alpha}, U_u \xi_{S,\alpha} \rangle.$$

There is no nontrivial generator hiding here. The self-adjoint generator is simply

$$D|q\rangle = (\log q)|q\rangle.$$

All arithmetic content is in the vector, not in the diagonal operator. The state moves; the generator does not.

Normalize the vector:

$$\Omega_{S,\alpha} = \frac{\xi_{S,\alpha}}{\|\xi_{S,\alpha}\|}.$$

Since

$$\|\xi_{S,\alpha}\|^2 = F_{S,\alpha}(0) = \prod_{p \in S} \frac{1 + p^{-\alpha}}{1 - p^{-\alpha}},$$

the normalized response is

$$R_{S,\alpha}(u) = \langle \Omega_{S,\alpha}, U_u \Omega_{S,\alpha} \rangle = \frac{F_{S,\alpha}(u)}{F_{S,\alpha}(0)} = \prod_{p \in S} \frac{(1 - p^{-\alpha})^2}{|1 - p^{-\alpha - iu}|^2}.$$

For  $\alpha > 1$ , the infinite-prime limit exists and gives

$$R_\alpha(u) = \frac{|\zeta(\alpha + iu)|^2}{\zeta(\alpha)^2}.$$

The same formula can be seen from a one-sided vector if one remembers to take memory rather than the raw response. Put

$$\omega_\sigma = \zeta(2\sigma)^{-1/2} \sum_{n \geq 1} n^{-\sigma} |n\rangle, \quad \sigma > 1/2.$$

Then

$$\langle \omega_\sigma, U_u \omega_\sigma \rangle = \frac{\zeta(2\sigma - iu)}{\zeta(2\sigma)},$$

and its autocorrelation has modulus square

$$|\langle \omega_\sigma, U_u \omega_\sigma \rangle|^2 = \frac{|\zeta(2\sigma + iu)|^2}{\zeta(2\sigma)^2}.$$

The bookkeeping is  $\alpha = 2\sigma$ : the absolutely convergent range  $\alpha > 1$  is exactly the one-sided range  $\sigma > 1/2$ .

The one-sided factor  $\zeta(\alpha + it)/\zeta(\alpha)$  is the classical Riemann zeta distribution: Khinchine proved it is an infinitely divisible characteristic function for  $\alpha > 1$ , and Lin and Hu developed the resulting distribution. The two-sided divisibility response is its symmetrized autocorrelation, the modulus square above.

As  $\alpha \downarrow 1$ , the normalized symmetrized response satisfies

$$R_\alpha(u) \rightarrow 0 \quad (u \neq 0),$$

because  $\zeta(\alpha)$  diverges at the pole while  $\zeta(1 + iu)$  is finite and nonzero for  $u \neq 0$ . In this sense the zeta-distribution vacuum forgets itself under every nonzero scale displacement at the pole boundary. The disappearance is powered by the pole of  $\zeta(s)$  at  $s = 1$  and kept clean by the classical nonvanishing of  $\zeta(1 + iu)$  for  $u \neq 0$ .

This response theorem does not replace the earlier failure. It explains it. The object does not cross the infinite-prime boundary as a Radon length measure. In the absolutely convergent range it crosses as a normalized autocorrelation. At the gcd exponent  $\alpha = 1/2$  one is far beyond the range where this normalized Euler-product response converges. The finite critical shadow is instead

$$F_{S,1/2}(u) = \prod_{p \in S} \frac{1 - p^{-1}}{|1 - p^{-1/2 - iu}|^2} = \zeta_S(1)^{-1} |\zeta_S(1/2 + iu)|^2,$$

where  $\zeta_S(s) = \prod_{p \in S} (1 - p^{-s})^{-1}$ . Thus the Poisson normalization is precisely the vanishing factor  $\zeta_S(1)^{-1}$ . Multiplying by the divergent normalization  $\zeta_S(1)$  recovers the squared finite Euler product on the critical line. This is not a probability limit. It is the beginning of a renormalization problem.

## ■ THE LOGARITHMIC DERIVATIVE ISOLATES PRIME POWERS

THE CORRECT  
TRANSFORMATION

The explicit formula does not use the Euler product itself. It uses its logarithmic derivative. That is the transformation that removes the rational-frequency clutter and leaves the prime powers.

Take logarithms:

$$\log F_S(u) = \sum_{p \in S} \log(1 - p^{-1}) + 2 \sum_{p \in S} \sum_{r \geq 1} \frac{p^{-r/2}}{r} \cos(ur \log p).$$

The product had arbitrary rational frequencies. The logarithm has only prime-power frequencies.

More generally, define

$$L_{S,\sigma}(u) = \log \prod_{p \in S} |1 - p^{-\sigma - iu}|^{-2}.$$

Then

$$L_{S,\sigma}(u) = 2 \sum_{p \in S} \sum_{r \geq 1} \frac{p^{-r\sigma}}{r} \cos(ur \log p),$$

and differentiating in the radial exponent gives

$$-\partial_\sigma L_{S,\sigma}(u) \Big|_{\sigma=1/2} = 2 \sum_{p \in S} \sum_{r \geq 1} (\log p) p^{-r/2} \cos(ur \log p).$$

There is a small but important bookkeeping choice here. The denominator-only object  $L_{S,\sigma}$  is used because the full normalized Poisson product is

$$F_{S,\sigma}(u) = \prod_{p \in S} P_{p^{-\sigma}}(u \log p) = \prod_{p \in S} (1 - p^{-2\sigma}) |1 - p^{-\sigma - iu}|^{-2}.$$

Thus

$$\log F_{S,\sigma}(u) = \sum_{p \in S} \log(1 - p^{-2\sigma}) + L_{S,\sigma}(u).$$

The first term is a zero-frequency normalization term. Its radial derivative at  $\sigma = 1/2$  contains

$$\sum_{p \in S} \frac{2(\log p) p^{-1}}{1 - p^{-1}},$$

which diverges as  $S$  grows. This is one visible sign that the raw positive products do not pass directly to the completed Weil distribution. The denominator logarithmic derivative isolates the prime-power part; the normalization, pole, trivial-zero, and archimedean terms belong to the completed explicit-formula bookkeeping.

On the length side, up to Fourier-normalization convention, this is the symmetrized prime-power distribution

$$\mathcal{P}_S = \sum_{p \in S} \sum_{r \geq 1} (\log p) p^{-r/2} (\delta_{r \log p} + \delta_{-r \log p}).$$

For a compactly supported test function  $\phi \in C_c^\infty(\mathbb{R})$  with support in  $[-R, R]$ , only prime powers with  $p^r \leq e^R$  can contribute. Once  $S$  contains all primes  $p \leq e^R$ , the value  $\mathcal{P}_S(\phi)$  has stabilized. Thus

$$\mathcal{P}_S \rightarrow \mathcal{P}$$

locally on compactly supported length-side tests, where

$$\mathcal{P} = \sum_{p,r \geq 1} (\log p) p^{-r/2} (\delta_{r \log p} + \delta_{-r \log p}).$$

This is the finite-place prime-power component of the explicit formula. It is the correct transformation:

$$\text{Poisson product} \rightarrow \text{logarithm} \rightarrow \text{radial derivative} \rightarrow \text{prime powers}.$$

The response formulation gives this transformation its probabilistic name. For  $\alpha > 1$ ,

$$\begin{aligned} \log R_\alpha(u) &= 2 \operatorname{Re}(\log \zeta(\alpha + iu) - \log \zeta(\alpha)) \\ &= \sum_{p,r \geq 1} \frac{p^{-r\alpha}}{r} (e^{iur \log p} + e^{-iur \log p} - 2). \end{aligned}$$

This is the Lévy–Khinchine decomposition of an infinitely divisible law, with symmetric prime-power Lévy measure

$$\nu_\alpha = \sum_{p,r \geq 1} \frac{p^{-r\alpha}}{r} (\delta_{r \log p} + \delta_{-r \log p}).$$

The explicit-formula prime-power distribution is the formal negative radial derivative of this Lévy measure at the critical exponent:

$$-\partial_\alpha \nu_\alpha \Big|_{\alpha=1/2} = \sum_{p,r \geq 1} (\log p) p^{-r/2} (\delta_{r \log p} + \delta_{-r \log p}).$$

This last line is a finite-cutoff identity before it is a limiting statement. It should not be read as saying that an infinitely divisible probability law already exists at  $\alpha = 1/2$ . It says that the prime-power side of the explicit formula is the critical radial derivative of the finite-place response's Lévy measure.

### THIRD SAFETY RAIL

Positivity of  $F_S$  cannot be transferred directly to positivity of the Weil functional. The valid path is more disciplined: positivity supplies the finite-place product geometry, the response formulation supplies the state interpretation, and the logarithmic derivative supplies the explicit-formula prime side. These are different operations, and differentiation need not preserve positivity. That is the third safety rail.

## ■ COMPLETION: TATE SUPPLIES THE GAMMA TERM, NOT WEIL POSITIVITY

THE LOCKED CHAMBER

At the finite places, the standard local vector is the characteristic function of the valuation ring. In Tate's thesis, the local zeta integral

$$Z(f, \chi) = \int_{F^\times} f(x) \chi(x) d^\times x$$

recovers the local  $L$ -factor for the standard nonarchimedean vector  $f = 1_{\mathcal{O}}$ , after the usual normalization. At the real place, the Gaussian

$$\Omega_\infty(x) = e^{-\pi x^2}$$

gives the archimedean gamma factor:

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^\times} e^{-\pi x^2} |x|^s d^\times x = \pi^{-s/2} \Gamma(s/2) = \Gamma_{\mathbb{R}}(s).$$

With the finite standard vector, the adelic vacuum is

$$\Omega = \Omega_\infty \otimes \prod_p 1_{\mathbb{Z}_p}.$$

Tate's global zeta integral then gives, in the basic Riemann case and up to standard conventions,

$$Z(\Omega, s) = \pi^{-s/2} \Gamma(s/2) \zeta(s).$$

The product formula for ideles,

$$|q|_\infty \prod_p |q|_p = 1 \quad (q \in \mathbb{Q}^\times),$$

locks the real and finite normalizations together.

This is unconditional. It explains why the archimedean Gaussian belongs in the same room as the finite-place Poisson geometry. But the completed zeta integral is not the Weil quadratic form. Tate gives analytic continuation and functional equation through harmonic analysis. Weil positivity is a separate statement about the explicit formula as a positive-type distribution.

So the completed object has three ingredients:

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{completed Weil distribution} \\ &= \text{pole terms} + \text{archimedean gamma term} - \text{prime-power term}, \end{aligned}$$

with signs depending on the chosen explicit-formula convention. The prime-power term is what the logarithmic derivative of the finite shadows isolates. The gamma term comes from the real Gaussian. The pole and trivial-zero corrections come from the completed function

$$\xi(s) = \frac{1}{2}s(s-1)\pi^{-s/2}\Gamma(s/2)\zeta(s).$$

The missing problem is now precise:

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**Boundary Positivity Problem.** Starting from the finite-place Poisson spectral geometry, construct the completed, renormalized log-scale distribution  $W$  whose finite-place component is the prime-power distribution above, whose archimedean component is the gamma contribution, and whose pole terms match the completed explicit formula. Then prove

$$W(h^* * h) \geq 0$$

for every test function  $h$  on log-scale.

---

By Weil's criterion, as stated in Bombieri's form, this positivity is equivalent to RH. It is not a final technical step. It is the locked chamber.

## ■ WEIL POSITIVITY AS POSITIVE TYPE ON LOG-SCALE

WHY THE CRITERION IS RH-SHAPED

The log-scale convention is simple and worth fixing. Let

$$h \in C_c^\infty(\mathbb{R}), \quad h^*(t) = \overline{h(-t)}, \quad \varphi = h^* * h.$$

With the Fourier convention

$$\hat{h}(u) = \int_{\mathbb{R}} h(t)e^{iut} dt,$$

one has

$$\hat{\varphi}(u) = |\hat{h}(u)|^2 \quad (u \in \mathbb{R}).$$

Now pass between logarithmic and multiplicative coordinates. Put

$$x = e^t, \quad h(t) = e^{t/2}g(e^t), \quad \text{equivalently} \quad g(x) = x^{-1/2}h(\log x).$$

For the Mellin transform

$$\tilde{g}(s) = \int_0^\infty g(x)x^s \frac{dx}{x},$$

this gives

$$\tilde{g}(1/2 + iu) = \int_{\mathbb{R}} h(t) e^{iut} dt = \hat{h}(u).$$

This is the square-root normalization in its cleanest form: Mellin transform on  $(0, \infty)$  becomes Fourier transform on  $\mathbb{R}$  along the critical line.

In one standard Bombieri-Weil formulation, the RH-strength quadratic expression is built from the nontrivial zeros by pairing values of the Mellin transform at  $\rho$  and at  $1 - \bar{\rho}$ . In log-scale notation, this is morally

$$Q(h) = \sum_{\rho} H(\rho) \overline{H(1 - \bar{\rho})}, \quad H(s) = \int_{\mathbb{R}} h(t) e^{(s-1/2)t} dt,$$

with the usual regularization and test-function restrictions of the explicit formula. If RH holds, every nontrivial zero has the form

$$\rho = 1/2 + i\gamma,$$

so

$$1 - \bar{\rho} = \rho,$$

and the zero side becomes a sum of squares:

$$Q(h) = \sum_{\gamma} |\hat{h}(\gamma)|^2.$$

If a zero leaves the critical line, the evaluation is no longer at a real Fourier frequency, and the square-norm reading breaks. This is the first-principles reason Weil positivity is RH-shaped.

A distribution  $W$  on  $\mathbb{R}$  is of positive type if

$$W(h^* * h) \geq 0$$

for every such  $h$ . The completed explicit formula defines the relevant  $W$  by equating the zero side with the prime-power, gamma, pole, and trivial-zero terms. Weil's criterion, in Bombieri's quadratic-functional form, says precisely that positivity of this completed functional is equivalent to RH.

If  $W$  were known to be positive type, the GNS construction would produce a Hilbert space representation and a cyclic vector  $\xi$  such that

$$W(h^* * h) = \|\pi(h)\xi\|^2.$$

That is already a length representation. It is not automatically a trace formula. A trace identity

$$W(h^* * h) = \text{Tr}(\pi(h)^* \pi(h))$$

is stronger than a GNS vector-state identity. The distinction is essential:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{positive-type distribution} &\Rightarrow \text{GNS Hilbert representation} \\ &\not\Rightarrow \text{trace formula without extra structure} . \end{aligned}$$

The Hilbert-Polya dream would require still more: a self-adjoint generator whose spectral distribution gives the zeros. Connes's trace formula program and the Connes-Consani-Marcolli trace-pairing formulation are attempts to build such extra structure. They do not make the gcd-kernel positivity equivalent to Weil positivity.

## ■ THE NO-LEAK CONDITION

AN OFF-LINE ZERO IS AN UNSTABLE MODE

Write a zero in the old coordinates,

$$\rho = \beta + i\gamma,$$

and follow its contribution into logarithmic scale. With  $x = e^t$  and square-root normalization  $x^{1/2} = e^{t/2}$ ,

$$\frac{x^\rho}{x^{1/2}\rho} = \frac{e^{(\beta-1/2)t}e^{i\gamma t}}{\rho}.$$

The factor  $e^{i\gamma t}$  is oscillation. The factor  $e^{(\beta-1/2)t}$  is the leak. If  $\beta = 1/2$ , the mode neither grows nor decays after square-root normalization. If  $\beta > 1/2$ , it grows exponentially as  $t \rightarrow +\infty$ ; if  $\beta < 1/2$ , its functional-equation partner at  $1 - \beta + i\gamma$  supplies the growing half. Either way, an off-line pair is no longer a unitary oscillation on log-scale.

Call this the No-Leak Condition:

after square-root normalization, every zero-pair contributes  
only pure oscillatory modes.

This is not an independent criterion for RH. It is the classical zero-location condition re-expressed in the coordinate used by the explicit formula. Conrey's survey reviews Riemann's formula for primes, the critical strip, the role of the real part  $\beta$ , and the square-root scale of the error term. The point of the re-expression is pedagogical and structural: in placement coordinates an off-line zero is a point slightly to the side of a line; in log-scale it is an unstable mode.

The language is different because the error is different. A misplaced point sounds small. A leaking mode changes the type of the system.

The corrected boundary question is not simply whether the completed function  $\xi(s)$  is a characteristic function. That neighborhood is already occupied. Biane, Pitman, and Yor relate Riemann's theta-integral representations of zeta and  $\xi$  to probability laws coming from sums of independent exponentials, Brownian motion, and Bessel processes. Nakamura studies complete Riemann zeta distributions built from ratios of the completed function  $\xi(s)$  and proves characteristic-function statements that are not themselves RH.

That warning matters. A probabilistic avatar of  $\xi$  is not automatically Weil positivity. The RH-strength object is the completed explicit-formula distribution, equivalently the logarithmic derivative and its zero-side quadratic form. Probability of the function and positivity of the Weil functional are different doors.

The finite-place construction therefore points to a more specific boundary-state problem:

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Does the family of finite-place vacuum responses admit a renormalized boundary limit, with the archimedean gamma term and pole corrections included, whose logarithmic derivative is the completed Weil distribution and whose positivity is inherited from a genuine state or trace construction?

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This is where recent probability and noncommutative geometry sit close to the sill. Saksman and Webb prove that random high shifts of  $\zeta(1/2 + it)$  converge, as generalized functions, to objects built from complex Gaussian multiplicative chaos; their result shows that the critical-line boundary of zeta has a rigorous renormalized probability theory. It does not provide a deterministic Weil-positive state, but it validates the idea that the critical boundary is a renormalization regime rather than an ordinary Euler-product limit.

On the archimedean side, Connes and Consani study Weil positivity and the trace formula at the single archimedean place; their abstract identifies the positivity mechanism with the trace of the scaling action compressed onto a Sonin-space complement. Their scaling Hamiltonian and later zeta-cycle work should

be treated as neighboring architecture, not as decoration. The finite-place response above is the other bank of the same crossing: trivial scaling generator, nontrivial state, boundary renormalization.

## ■ WHERE THE MODULAR PROPOSAL BELONGS

A CONDITIONAL CODA, NOT A PROOF ENGINE

The operator-algebraic language belongs as a conditional coda, not a proof engine.

Tomita-Takesaki theory says that a von Neumann algebra with a cyclic and separating vector has a modular operator  $\Delta$ , a modular conjugation  $J$ , and a canonical modular automorphism group

$$\sigma_t(A) = \Delta^{it} A \Delta^{-it}.$$

The vector induces a faithful normal state, and the modular flow is trivial precisely in the tracial case. This is why modular theory is tempting: it manufactures a canonical time from the pair consisting of an algebra and a state.

But it does not manufacture the Riemann zeros. It does not identify its generator with the zeta spectrum. It does not turn the gcd kernel into the Weil functional. The conditional statement is:

### — THE CONDITIONAL STATEMENT

If an arithmetic von Neumann algebra and faithful state were constructed whose modular flow realized the completed explicit formula, then Tomita-Takesaki theory would supply a canonical self-adjoint modular generator. The decisive remaining problem would still be to prove that the resulting distribution is the Weil distribution and that its relevant pairing is positive.

This is where Bost and Connes remain relevant. Their number-theoretic  $C^*$ -dynamical system has partition function  $\zeta$  and a canonical one-parameter dynamics. Connes's adèle-class-space program works in the larger noncommutative space where scaling is part of the geometry. These are not consequences of the gcd kernel. They are neighboring constructions that show the kind of noncommutative crossing a genuine trace formula may require.

So the chain should be read this way:

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{finite-place divisibility spectrum} \Rightarrow \text{logarithmic derivative gives prime powers} \\ &\Rightarrow \text{completion adds gamma and pole terms} \Rightarrow \text{Weil positivity is the RH-strength gate.} \end{aligned}$$

The modular proposal is a possible architecture for realizing the final distribution, not a substitute for proving its positivity.

## ■ THE RELIEF

THE HISTORICAL REMEDY IS A CHANGE OF VENUE

The analogy with Dedekind cuts is not proof. It is a warning about coordinates.

In the Pythagorean world, the diagonal of the unit square did not fit the available type of number. The repair was not to find a better rational approximation; it was to enlarge the ontology of number until the gap itself became an object. Dedekind's cut made an irrational number from the partition it imposed on the rationals.

The analogy for RH is not that we may decree an operator and be done. A decree cannot supply the object it presupposes. The analogy is only this: when a persistent arithmetic obstruction has the shape of a missing type, the history of mathematics often resolves it by changing venue.

The safer modern precedent is the Weil conjectures. The function-field RH became a theorem through cohomological machinery. Grothendieck's étale cohomology supplied a venue in which zeta functions became characteristic polynomials of Frobenius acting on cohomology, and Deligne proved the decisive

eigenvalue estimate in La conjecture de Weil I. The lesson is not that the number-field case is solved by analogy. The lesson is that the right venue can make an unstable statement well-typed.

For the number field  $\mathbb{Q}$ , no comparable cohomology is constructed here. The essay's contribution is not to produce it. The contribution is to identify a finite-place spectral geometry that such a construction would need to absorb, and to state exactly where absorption fails without the completed Weil positivity.

## ■ THE FINITE-PLACE SPECTRAL AND BOUNDARY THEOREM

THE UNCONDITIONAL  
CORE, STATED ONCE

The transformations line up in three stages. First comes the finite-place geometry:

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{divisibility sets in } \hat{\mathbb{Z}} \Rightarrow \text{normalized gcd Gram kernel} \Rightarrow \\ &\text{positive-definite } \kappa \text{ on } \mathbb{Q}_+^\times \Rightarrow \text{prime-torus Poisson spectral measure} . \end{aligned}$$

Then comes the log-scale boundary:

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{log-scale flow} \Rightarrow \text{direct finite shadows fail to converge to } W \\ &\Rightarrow \text{logarithmic radial derivative isolates prime powers} . \end{aligned}$$

Then comes completion:

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{Tate completion supplies gamma factor and product-formula normalization} \\ &\Rightarrow \text{completed explicit formula} \Rightarrow \text{Weil positivity, equivalent to RH} . \end{aligned}$$

The theorem is therefore not a theorem about RH. It is a theorem about the finite-place side and its boundary behavior.

**Finite-place spectral and boundary theorem.** The normalized gcd kernel extends to the positive-definite function

$$\kappa(q) = \prod_p p^{-|v_p(q)|/2}$$

on  $\mathbb{Q}_+^\times$ . Its Bochner spectral measure on the prime torus  $\mathbb{T}^{\mathcal{P}}$  is the product of local Poisson measures

$$d\mu_p(e^{i\theta}) = \frac{1 - p^{-1}}{|1 - p^{-1/2}e^{i\theta}|^2} \frac{d\theta}{2\pi} .$$

More generally, the family  $\mu_\sigma = \bigotimes_p P_{p^{-\sigma}} d\theta_p / (2\pi)$  is equivalent to Haar measure for  $\sigma > 1/2$  and singular for  $0 < \sigma \leq 1/2$ ; for every nonzero log-scale shift, the same threshold governs whether the scale flow preserves the measure class of  $\mu_\sigma$  in the Kakutani sense. Pulling finite products along the log-scale flow  $u \mapsto (p^{iu})_p$  gives positive finite Euler shadows. As length-side measures these shadows do not converge directly to the completed Weil functional: they have arbitrary rational frequencies and non-Radon mass accumulation near zero. As Hilbert-space responses, however, each finite shadow is exactly a matrix coefficient of the diagonal generator  $D|q\rangle = (\log q)|q\rangle$ . In the absolutely convergent normalized range this response becomes the symmetrized autocorrelation of the Riemann zeta distribution,  $|\zeta(\alpha + iu)|^2 / \zeta(\alpha)^2$ . The logarithmic radial derivatives of the finite responses isolate the prime-power distribution

$$\sum_{p,r \geq 1} (\log p) p^{-r/2} (\delta_{r \log p} + \delta_{-r \log p}) ,$$

which is the finite-place component of the explicit formula. The completed Weil distribution requires the archimedean gamma term and pole/trivial-zero corrections, and its positivity is equivalent to RH.

## ■ THE YIELD

WHAT THE VENUE HAS GROWN

A venue is tested by what it grows. The first edition argued that divisibility-as-length is the right ground; since then, the ground has begun producing questions and answers of its own. They are recorded in the same currencies as everything else.

The first is a portrait, computed rather than proved. Ask the finite kernel  $K_N$  for its softest direction, the eigenvector of the smallest eigenvalue, and the answer, computed through  $N = 25600$ , concentrates on smooth numbers and carries the signs of the Liouville function with mass-weighted agreement above 0.999. The thesis of this motion is that cancellation does not know its sign until it is represented as length. Represented as length and asked where it is weakest, the geometry answers with the signs of cancellation. No one put them there.

The second is a theorem, machine-checked as `primorial_rayleigh_upper_bound`. The portrait suggests the witness: Möbius signs on the divisors of a primorial. Whenever  $\prod_{p \leq y} p \leq N$ ,

$$\lambda_{\min}(K_N) \leq \prod_{p \leq y} (1 - p^{-1/2}).$$

It was conjectured from the portrait, derived on paper, validated numerically to fifteen digits, and then checked by the kernel. To the author's knowledge the bound is new. It is small mathematics, but it is mathematics the venue produced, by the full route: observe, conjecture, derive, validate, verify.

The third is an open problem, posed here with numerics to  $N = 1.3 \times 10^7$ . The true bottom edge falls faster than the bound: the data reject  $c/(\log N)^2$  decisively, and every product-type test family caps short of the observed rate. The honest target is

$$\lambda_{\min}(K_N) = \exp(-(\log N)^{1/2+o(1)}),$$

and the mechanism is unexplained: the minimizer entangles across primes in a way no per-prime construction reproduces. The GCD-sums literature, through Bondarenko and Seip, works the top of this spectrum; the bottom edge at the critical exponent appears untouched. The full dossier, with the attack routes, is in the repository's open-problem notes.

The fourth is a symmetry with an unexplained constant. Across five decades of  $N$ , the product  $\lambda_{\min} \cdot \lambda_{\max}$  holds near 0.389 to within one percent. The symmetry beneath it is exact and machine-checked: rotating every circle of the prime torus by  $\pi$ , which sends the Poisson ratio  $a$  to  $-a$ , acts on the kernel precisely as conjugation by the Liouville signs. The involution preserves the spectrum, and the local reciprocity  $P_a(0) P_a(\pi) = 1$  pairs the two poles of each circle. The Perron-positive top of the spectrum and the Liouville-signed bottom are the two poles of one symmetry; the constant is its truncation deficit, and it is open.

There is also a debt paid outward. The dichotomy this motion leans on, Kakutani's of 1948, had never been formalized in a proof assistant. It now is, both directions, together with the Hellinger affinity and the product-measure instruments it requires, and the formalization is being prepared for the common library. A change of venue that only consumed instruments would be suspect. This one has begun returning them.

None of this touches the locked chamber. The yield is evidence of a different kind. The historical pattern this motion invokes did not end when the impossible object was installed; the rebuilt coordinates then

began asking questions the old coordinates could not phrase. A question about the softest direction of divisibility-as-length does not exist in placement coordinates. The venue has started asking it.

## ■ THE FOCUS

WHOM THE MOTION ADDRESSES

It is fair to ask whom the motion addresses. Not Connes; he is already inside the courtroom, and every unconditional object above sits on a record he helped write. The motion is addressed to the field's self-understanding of what kind of statement the Hypothesis is. Motions do not introduce evidence. They ask the court to change the question being tried. This edition, though, arrives with its record attached. The companion repository is the docket: the exhibits build, and the failures are verified with the same rigor as the successes.

The motion is this:

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RH should be approached as a boundary-positivity problem for a completed log-scale distribution. The finite-place gcd kernel supplies a canonical positive geometry at the near boundary. The missing step is not more positivity in general; it is the precise survival, or reconstruction, of positivity after logarithmic differentiation, archimedean completion, and renormalization into Weil's explicit formula.

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The fog is not everywhere. It has one gate:

$$W(h^* * h) \geq 0.$$

By Weil, that gate is RH.

The zeta zeros stand to arithmetic-at-infinity as the diagonal stood to the Pythagorean world. The record of the field, ancient and modern alike, says that such absences are resolved in one motion, and that the motion is total: rebuild the field around the impossibility until the impossibility is digested as a type.

The critical line is where arithmetic should be recentered next.

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